

Which App?

When you sit down to use AI, your first decision is which app to download and use. Three dominate: ChatGPT from OpenAI, Claude from Anthropic, and Gemini from Google. All three can chat, write, code, and answer questions. So why does it matter which one you pick?



DIFFERENT PHILOSOPHIES

Think about it like this. In-N-Out and McDonald's both sell cheeseburgers, built from roughly the same ingredients. They're still completely different experiences, because each company has a different idea of what a burger place should be. One does a tiny menu with everything made fresh. The other is engineered for speed, scale, and being exactly the same in every city on Earth.

The big three AI apps work the same way. They're all Generative AI, trained on much of the same internet. But each company trains its model with different priorities and rules.

Those choices shape much of how each app differs: how it feels, what it's good at, what it gets wrong. Underneath, each one is built around a different core philosophy.

The big three, side by side		
CHATGPT The Anything Box	CLAUDE The Thinking Partner	GEMINI Built Into Google
WHAT IT IS One general-purpose AI app aimed at a wide audience. It's still many people's default starting point.	WHAT IT IS Built by Anthropic with an explicit safety-and-behavior philosophy. Often strong when careful reasoning and accuracy matter most.	WHAT IT IS Google's AI assistant, strongest when the task connects to the Google tools you already use.
BEST FOR ✓ Brainstorming ✓ Quick drafts ✓ Varied everyday tasks ✓ General multimodal work with text, voice, images, files, and data	BEST FOR ✓ Coding and code review ✓ Analysis and research ✓ Long-form writing ✓ Careful critique when the stakes are higher, but still verify	BEST FOR ✓ Current events ✓ Live web research ✓ Summarizing YouTube videos and Drive files ✓ Drafting in Gmail and Docs
OPENAI ASKS <i>How do we put capable AI in everyone's hands?</i>	ANTHROPIC ASKS <i>How do we build powerful AI we can actually trust?</i>	GOOGLE ASKS <i>How do we put AI inside the tools people already use?</i>

Each philosophy turns into a different kind of strength. ChatGPT is built for breadth. Claude is built for depth. Gemini is built for context.

WHICH APP SHOULD YOU USE?

Honest answer: for most of what you'll do, any of the three works. Don't agonize over the choice.

Pick one as your home base and learn it well: its settings, its features, its quirks. Knowing one app deeply beats dabbling in all three. As your AI use grows, branch out to another when a job clearly fits its strength. And expect those strengths to keep moving: the three leapfrog each other, so the gap you remember may already be gone.

A power move for later: when an answer really matters, ask the same question in a second app. Two differently trained models agreeing is real evidence. If they disagree, you know exactly where to dig.

A REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Hi. This is Nate and Luke again. When we built this course, we used different apps for different jobs. Our dad knows the strengths of each, and guided us into the right app for the task at hand.

ChatGPT	Claude	Gemini
✓ Brainstorming content and TRY ITs ✓ Illustrations of us in Dallas Stars jerseys	✓ Claude Code wrote the lessons from plain English ✓ Claude Design styled the pages	✓ Pulling in current information ✓ Fact-checking what we used

We leaned on one more tool: NotebookLM, which is powered by Gemini. Its job was the videos in this course. We uploaded a lesson's content, clicked a button, and NotebookLM did the rest.

🔑 The skills transfer. The app is just where you practice them. Everything this course teaches, prompting, checking, staying in charge, works the same in all three. Which app you pick matters far less than how well you learn to drive it.